



Learning Space

IAS MAINS 2020

ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE

CASE STUDIES

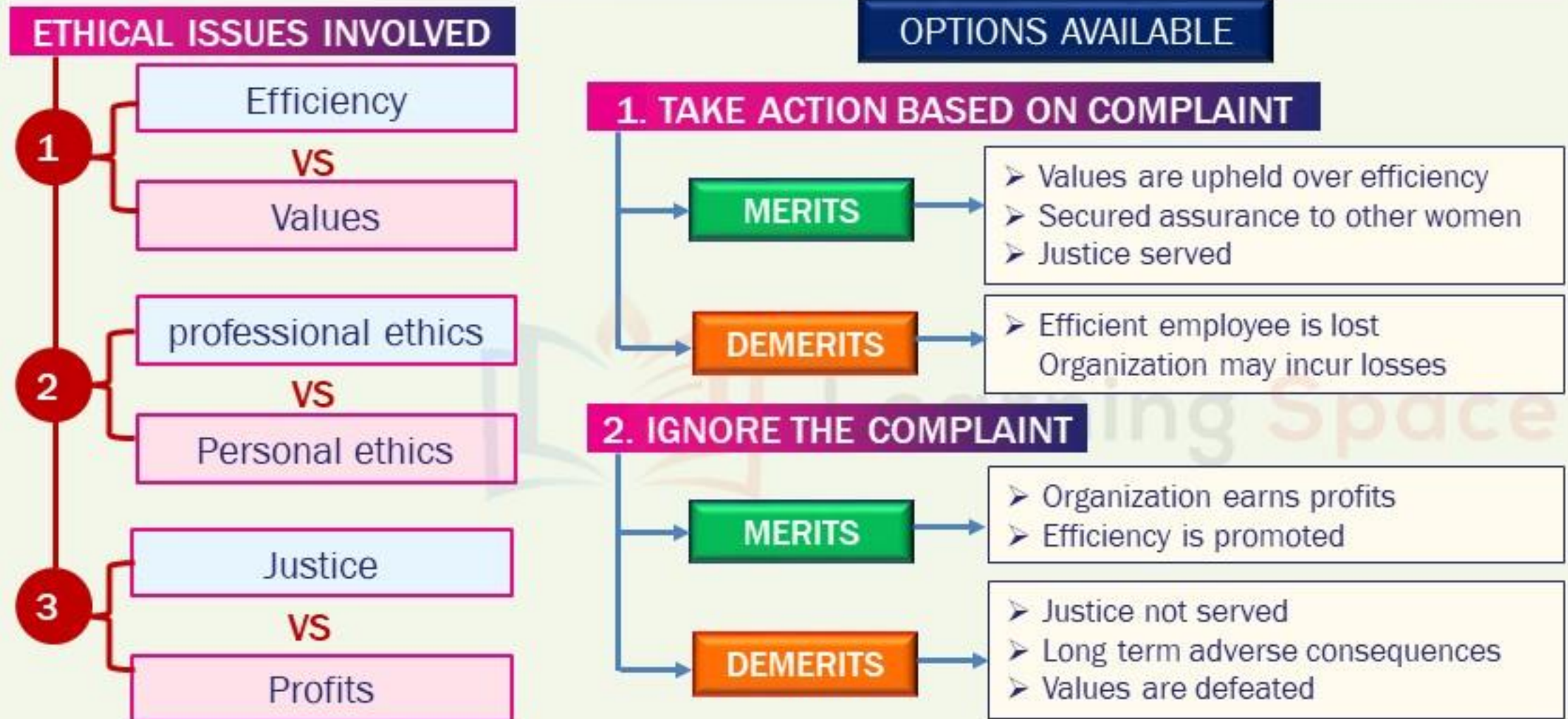
MODULE - 15

CASE STUDY - 15

Mr A has been an employee of the company in which you are working as the Chief Executive Officer (CEO). Mr A is efficient at work and has proved time again that he is an invaluable asset to the organization by playing a key role in boosting the revenue of the company. He is also known for punctuality and discipline at work. One day, Mrs X, with a forlorn expression, submitted her resignation stating that she has been harassed physically and verbally by Mr A and that she can not take it any longer.

What options do you, the Chief Executive Officer of the organization, have in dealing with the situation? Justify your choice. (250 words)

The case narrates the difficulties of women in unsecured work space, often seen in society.



As the CEO of the organization, I take the following action:

- Request Mrs X to withhold her resignation and promise to take action on the basis of complaint.
 - Form a committee of female employees to investigate the complaint in 24 hrs.
 - Ask Mr. A to recuse himself from his position to ensure impartial investigation.
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| <ul style="list-style-type: none">➤ If Mr. A is found guilty:<ul style="list-style-type: none">✓ Remove him from the position✓ File complaint with police✓ Ask Mrs X to join her job | <ul style="list-style-type: none">➤ If Mr. A is not found guilty:<ul style="list-style-type: none">✓ Ask Mrs X to explain such unfounded complaint✓ Accept her resignation✓ Explain to Mr A that the procedure was necessary |
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REASONS FOR THE JUSTIFICATION

- Due process of law to be followed.
- Unethical behavior can never be accepted.
- If action is not taken, it affects the image of the organization, and other employees may also resign feeling the workplace as unsafe.

LONG TERM MEASURES

- Install CCTV cameras.
- Put on notice board, the Supreme Court Visakha guide lines.
- Implement code of ethics for employees.

CONCLUSION

Efficiency can be bought and sold in market for a price, but not values.

As the chief Executive officer of the organisation, the options ahead of me were:

A) ACCEPT RESIGNATION OF Mrs X**PROS**

- Mr. A will continue to give his efforts to organisation, through which company's revenue will increase.
- The discussion on harassment issue ends, without affecting the fame of the company.

CONS

- If Mrs. X's claims were genuine, her resignation would lead to loss of efficient member to company. There are also chances that she might file a complaint with police which may destroy company's reputation badly.
- Mr. A will be left unpunished for his guilt and may harass other women employees.

B) TERMINATE Mr A FROM THE COMPANY**PROS**

- Mrs. X will remain with the company and feel content that she has received justice.

CONS

- Company will lose an efficient employee which may impact its revenue.
- There are also chances that Mrs. X's claims were fake. In that case Mr A will miss the opportunity to be heard.

C) THE RIGHT PATH

Conduct an informal inquiry by the CEO himself to find the past present status of relations between Mr. A and Mrs. X. If something abnormal was noticed, order a formal inquiry to find the facts as well as give opportunity for both to express their views. If Mr. A was proven guilty, terminate him. If Mrs. X claims were proven fake, accept the resignation while warning her not to repeat such actions in future.

PROS

- An informal inquiry instead of a formal one protects privacy of Mrs. X, Mr. A as well as the company.
- Terminating Mr. A, if proven guilty would improve trust of employees on the company as well as prevent any future harassment complaints by other women,

CONS

- An asset to the company will be lost. Company should not undermine its values for the sake of revenue.

CONCLUSION

Option (c) is the best option considering various facts like efficiency of Mr A, privacy of Mrs X and Value system of the company.

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SINCERE THANKS
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